

Camera Features

If just pointing and shooting gave you images of absolute perfection, photography competitions would have vanished ages ago. Although you may not prefer signing up for any of those, but you'd still want to take better pictures, right? Well, then you'll first have to get a grip on the features that your camera offers you, and how best you can put them to use.

Digital camera features differ greatly from model to model. Some might be indispensable, while others might be required for highly specialised applications. However, no digital camera worth its microprocessor would lack the very basic features, viz. image stabilisation, exposure compensation and flash sync.

3.1 Image Stabilisation

Picture this – you're waiting in line for hours to see your favourite movie star to take his / her picture. The moment finally arrives and you take the snap... but damn! The photo is out of focus, and the celebrity looks like a bad dream. What went wrong? Probably, shaky hands. Besides, if there's very little natural light for the camera to use, the camera would inevitably slow down the shutter speed, lengthening the exposure time which could be disastrous. In such circumstances, you could try tucking your elbows up against your ribs while taking a shot (this looks pretty weird, but often helps to keep the hands steady). Alternatively, you could just use the IS feature on your camera.

What is Image Stabilisation (IS)?

Camera manufacturers have come to the rescue with something called image stabilisation (IS). IS is what Canon (the first to produce the Optical Image Stabilization technology) calls it. Nevertheless, different manufacturers tag it differently (VR – or Vibration Reduction in Nikon, SSS – or Super